TCK Workshop

THE COMPASS

TCK WORKSHOP

Academic English Proficiency Check

Question Booklet / 問題冊子

Name / 氏名：

Date / 受験日：　　年　　月　　日

Section	内容	問題数	配点
A. Listening	Short Conversations + Academic Talk	10問	15点
B. Grammar	Sentence Completion + Error Identification	10問	15点
C. Vocabulary	Words in Context + Synonyms + Word Formation	15問	15点
D. Reading	Fiction Passage + Non-fiction Passage	15問	30点
E. Writing	Summary (45–55 words) + Opinion Essay (150–200 words)	2問	25点
TOTAL		**52問**	**100点**

- 試験時間は**80分**です。
- リスニング（Section A）の音声は**1回のみ**再生されます（約9分）。音声開始前に設問に目を通しておきましょう。
- 選択問題は解答用紙の記号を**○で囲んで**ください。記述問題は解答用紙に記入してください。
- Writing（Section E）は問題冊子の解答欄に直接書いてください。

SECTION A Listening Comprehension / 15 pts

🎧 *音声を聞いて答えてください。音声は1回のみ流れます。/ The audio will be played only once.*

Part 1 — Short Conversations

Listen to each short conversation, then choose the best answer for each question.

1. (1pt) What problem does the woman have?

   A. She lost her boarding pass
   B. Her flight has been rescheduled
   C. She missed the deadline for check-in
   D. Her luggage exceeds the weight limit

2. (1pt) What does the boy suggest they do about the group project?

   A. Ask the teacher for an extension
   B. Divide the remaining tasks among the members
   C. Start the project over from scratch
   D. Meet after school to finish it together

3. (1pt) What can be inferred about the woman's attitude?

   A. She is pleased with the result
   B. She is disappointed but tries to be positive
   C. She is angry at her colleague
   D. She doesn't care about the outcome

4. (1pt) What does the man mean when he says, "That's easier said than done"?

   A. He agrees with the suggestion
   B. He thinks the idea is simple
   C. He believes it is difficult in practice
   D. He has already tried the approach

5. (1pt) What is the speaker implying about the school's new policy?

   A. It will solve most of the existing problems
   B. It sounds good in theory but may not work
   C. It has been in place for several years
   D. It is exactly what the school needed

Part 2 — Longer Passage: Coral Reefs

Listen to the following academic talk, then answer the questions below.

6. (2pts) According to the speaker, what role do coral reefs play in the ocean ecosystem?

   A. They regulate the temperature of ocean water
   B. They provide shelter and food for many marine species
   C. They produce most of the world's oxygen
   D. They prevent pollution from reaching the deep ocean

7. (2pts) According to the speaker, what happens when water temperatures rise?

   A. Fish populations increase rapidly
   B. Coral pushes out the algae living inside it
   C. New coral species begin to grow
   D. Marine animals move to land

8. (2pts) Why does the speaker mention the Great Barrier Reef?

   A. To give an example of a reef that has recovered fully
   B. To show how large the damage from bleaching can be
   C. To compare it favorably with other reefs
   D. To argue that tourism should be banned there

9. (2pts) What does the speaker imply about the future of coral reefs?

   A. Recovery is certain with current efforts
   B. The situation is serious but not hopeless
   C. Scientists have solved the problem
   D. Nothing can reverse the damage

10. (2pts) Which best describes the speaker's tone throughout the talk?

A. Alarmed and pessimistic
B. Neutral and detached
C. Concerned but cautiously hopeful
D. Amused and sarcastic

SECTION B Grammar & Usage / 15 pts

Part 1 — Sentence Completion

Choose the word or phrase that best completes each sentence.

11. (1pt) By the time she arrived at school, the first class _____ already.

A. starts
B. started
C. had started
D. has started

12. (1pt) The students were told that the field trip _____ if the weather did not improve.

A. will cancel
B. would be canceled
C. is canceled
D. has been canceled

13. (1pt) The book, _____ was written by a Japanese author, has been translated into 30 languages.

A. that
B. which
C. what
D. who

14. (1pt) I wish I _____ a musical instrument when I was younger.

A. learn
B. had learned
C. have learned
D. would learn

15. (1pt) It is essential that every student _____ the safety rules during experiments.

A. follows
B. follow
C. will follow
D. followed

Part 2 — Error Identification

Each sentence below has one error. Circle the letter (A–D) of the underlined part that contains the error.

16. (2pts)

The number of students$_{A}$ who is participating$_{B}$ in the science fair$_{C}$ has increased this year.$_{D}$

17. (2pts)

By the time we arrived,$_{A}$ the flight$_{B}$ has already departed$_{C}$ from the gate.$_{D}$

18. (2pts)

Despite$_{A}$ to feel$_{B}$ exhausted, the children$_{C}$ kept playing outside.$_{D}$

19. (2pts)

Not only$_{A}$ she finished$_{B}$ the race, but she also$_{C}$ set a new record.$_{D}$

20. (2pts)

If I$_{A}$ would have known$_{B}$ about the exam, I$_{C}$ would have studied harder.$_{D}$

SECTION C Vocabulary / 15 pts

Part 1 — Words in Context

Choose the word that best fits in the blank.

21. (1pt) The school decided to _____ its dress code after receiving complaints from parents.

A. revise
B. expand
C. reject
D. restore

22. (1pt) The documentary _____ a number of important issues that people tend to overlook.

A. addresses
B. accesses
C. assesses
D. assumes

23. (1pt) The government decided to _____ the old law and replace it with a modern one.

A. reinforce
B. abolish
C. establish
D. promote

24. (1pt) A _____ in the computer system caused problems for the entire school.

A. glitch
B. blackout
C. break
D. leak

25. (1pt) The scientist's groundbreaking theory was initially met with _____ by the academic community.

A. enthusiasm
B. skepticism
C. ignorance
D. sympathy

Part 2 — Synonyms

Choose the word closest in meaning to the underlined word.

26. (1pt) The company had to withdraw the product after customers reported safety concerns.

A. advertise
B. recall
C. launch
D. improve

27. (1pt) Her candid response surprised everyone at the meeting.

A. rehearsed
B. honest
C. unclear
D. cautious

28. (1pt) The island's ecosystem is extremely fragile and must be carefully protected.

A. resilient
B. stable
C. delicate
D. isolated

29. (1pt) The detective tried to unravel the mystery surrounding the missing artifact.

A. complicate
B. solve
C. create
D. ignore

30. (1pt) The teacher's meticulous preparation ensured the lesson went smoothly.

A. hasty
B. thorough
C. casual
D. irregular

Part 3 — Word Formation

Write the correct form of the word given in brackets.

31. (1pt) The _____ of plastic bags has been banned in several countries. [USE]

32. (1pt) Switching to renewable energy is _____ for reducing carbon emissions. [ESSENCE]

33. (1pt) The _____ of the new hospital will take about two years. [CONSTRUCT]

34. (1pt) Many parents were _____ with the school's sudden decision and signed a petition against it. [SATISFY]

35. (1pt) The children showed remarkable _____ by solving the puzzle entirely on their own. [RESOURCE]

SECTION D Reading Comprehension / 30 pts

Passage 1 — Fiction

Read the passage, then answer the questions.

Passage 1 — Fiction

[1] Lena pressed her forehead against the cold window of the bus. Outside, the streets of her new town slid by like a film she hadn't asked to watch. Everything was gray — the sky, the pavement, even the faces of people waiting at the crosswalk.

[2] "You'll love it once you settle in," her mother had said, as if settling in were something you could do the way you unpacked a suitcase — mechanically, one item at a time. But Lena knew better. She had left behind more than a house. She had left behind the jasmine-scented garden where she used to read until the sun set, the corner shop where Mr. Nakamura saved her favorite melon bread, and the laughter of friends who understood her without needing words.

[3] The bus lurched to a stop, and a girl about Lena's age climbed on, carrying a violin case. She sat across the aisle and, after a moment, caught Lena's eye. "First day?" she asked, as if it were written on Lena's face. Lena nodded.

[4] "I moved here two years ago from Singapore," the girl said. "I cried every day for a month. Then one day I stopped — not because things got better, but because I found something worth getting up for." She tapped the violin case and smiled.

[5] Lena looked at the girl — at the easy way she balanced between the memory of somewhere else and the reality of here — and felt, for the first time since the move, something that was not quite hope but was perhaps its quieter cousin: curiosity.

36. (2pts) How does Lena feel at the beginning of the story?

A. Excited about exploring a new town
B. Disconnected and unhappy about the move
C. Angry at her mother for moving
D. Nervous about starting at a new school

37. (2pts) What do the jasmine garden, corner shop, and friends represent to Lena?

A. Things she needs to forget in order to move on
B. A sense of belonging that she has lost
C. Problems she wanted to escape from
D. Memories that she exaggerates because she is sad

38. (2pts) The comparison to "unpacking a suitcase" suggests that —

A. Lena has very few belongings to unpack
B. Her mother understands how difficult the move is
C. Adjusting to a new place is not as simple as her mother implies
D. Lena prefers to organize before making friends

39. (2pts) Why does the girl on the bus mention her violin?

A. To show off her musical talent
B. To suggest that finding a passion can help you cope with change
C. To convince Lena to join a music class
D. To warn Lena that the town will never feel like home

40. (2pts) "Not quite hope but perhaps its quieter cousin: curiosity" — what does this mean?

A. Lena now feels fully confident about her new life
B. Lena is beginning to feel a subtle, positive interest in what lies ahead
C. Lena realizes she has nothing in common with the girl
D. Lena decides to pretend to be happy

41. (2pts) What genre does this passage belong to?

A. Science fiction
B. Historical non-fiction
C. Realistic fiction
D. Fantasy

42. (2pts) Which word best describes the overall tone of this passage?

A. Humorous
B. Bittersweet
C. Frightening
D. Indifferent

Passage 2 — Non-fiction

Read the passage, then answer the questions.

Passage 2 — Non-fiction: Sleep & Learning

[1] Sleep plays a far more important role in learning than most students realize. Research at Harvard Medical School found that students who slept well after studying performed 20 to 30 percent better on tests than those who stayed awake. During sleep, the brain replays and strengthens the connections formed during the day — a process called **memory consolidation**.

[2] Sleep deprivation also impairs the **prefrontal cortex**, the part of the brain responsible for concentration, decision-making, and creative problem-solving. This means that staying up all night before an exam — a practice known as "pulling an all-nighter" — may actually lead to worse performance, not better.

[3] Experts recommend 9 to 11 hours of sleep per night for school-age children. However, a growing number of students report sleeping fewer than 7 hours due to homework, extracurricular activities, and screen time. Some schools have responded by pushing back morning start times, and early results suggest that even a 30-minute delay can improve both grades and attendance.

[4] Critics argue that later start times create logistical problems for parents and disrupt bus schedules. Nevertheless, advocates insist that the academic and health benefits far **outweigh** the inconveniences. As one researcher noted, "We would never ask students to run a marathon without proper nutrition. Why do we ask them to learn without proper sleep?"

43. (2pts) What is the author's main argument in this passage?

A. Schools should teach students about brain science
B. Getting enough sleep is crucial for academic success
C. Homework should be reduced for younger students
D. Medical research should focus on children's health

44. (2pts) According to the passage, what is the gap between experts' recommendation and students' actual behavior?

A. Experts say 9–11 hours, but many students sleep fewer than 7
B. Experts say 7–9 hours, but most students sleep only 5
C. Experts say 11–13 hours, but students sleep 9–10
D. Experts say 8 hours, but students prefer to stay up late

45. (2pts) The phrase "memory consolidation" in paragraph 1 refers to —

A. Forgetting unimportant information during sleep
B. The brain's process of strengthening what was learned
C. A medical condition caused by lack of sleep
D. A type of exam given at Harvard Medical School

46. (2pts) Why might "pulling an all-nighter" actually hurt exam performance?

A. Students forget to eat breakfast the next morning
B. Sleep deprivation weakens the part of the brain used for thinking
C. Teachers give harder tests in the morning
D. Students cannot bring notes into the exam

47. (2pts) What does the word "outweigh" in paragraph 4 mean?

A. To be heavier in physical weight
B. To be more important or valuable than
C. To become less significant over time
D. To cause more problems than expected

48. (2pts) What is the purpose of the final sentence ("We would never ask students to run a marathon...")?

A. To compare athletic training with academic study using analogy
B. To suggest that running is more important than studying
C. To prove that sleep research is unreliable
D. To argue that schools should add more PE classes

49. (2pts) What is the purpose of paragraph 4 in relation to the rest of the passage?

A. To prove that later start times are impossible to implement
B. To present an opposing viewpoint and respond to it
C. To introduce a completely different topic
D. To summarize all the previous paragraphs

50. (2pts) Name TWO reasons why many students are not getting enough sleep, according to the passage. Write in a complete sentence.

→ 解答用紙に記入

SECTION E Writing / 25 pts

Part 1 — Summary Writing (10 pts)

Reread Passage 2 (Non-fiction about sleep) and write a summary in 45–55 words. Include the main idea and key points. Do NOT copy sentences from the passage.

Words: _____ (45–55 words)

Part 2 — Opinion Essay (15 pts)

Choose ONE topic below (check the box), then write 150–200 words. Include an introduction, body, and conclusion.

☐ **Topic A** "Students learn more from their classmates than from their teachers." Do you agree or disagree?

☐ **Topic B** Some people believe children should grow up in one country. Others say living in multiple countries is beneficial. Which do you support?

Part 2 — Opinion Essay（解答欄）　Topic: A ・ B

Words: _____ （150–200 words）

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